

My professional identity has evolved significantly through deepened understanding of the counseling field and its structure. I have progressed from initial exploration of professional organizations like the American Counseling Association and Texas Counseling Association to active engagement with the practical and ethical frameworks that guide professional practice. The completion of my Mandatory Reporting Community Response training demonstrates my commitment to understanding the legal responsibilities and protective duties central to client welfare. Through research into professional standards and conference attendance opportunities, I have established myself as a member of the counseling community rather than simply studying counseling theory. This has moved me to actively participate in the system, ethics codes, and advocacy efforts that define our profession.

Clinically and ethically, I have developed skills in ethical reasoning and decision-making through assignments such as my Case Study Analysis work, where I have practiced examining real counseling scenarios and identifying not only what skills were used, but whether they align with our professional ethical standards and responsibilities. By analyzing counselor responses, I have learned to think critically about the ethical implications of specific interventions while considering questions of informed consent, confidentiality, appropriate boundaries, and client welfare essential in every clinical decision. My internship experience analyzing actual counseling work has allowed me to move beyond memorizing ethics codes to understanding how ethical principles manifest in real-world practice. This progression reflects growing competence in recognizing ethical dilemmas, considering multiple perspectives, and making decisions that protect clients.